

● REC

KILLER

INFLUENCE

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Logline: A cadre of superstar influencers wake up trapped on a sealed soundstage. To survive, they must produce the most terrifying viral scenes on command—and there can only be one winner.

Hook & Positioning

Elevated survival-horror for the algorithm age

- High-concept: SAW-like engineered set-piece kills meet SQUID GAME-style elimination rounds.
- One-location pressure cooker: a modular soundstage that reconfigures into traps and sets.
- A meta-viral engine: survival is tied to views, shares, and 'closed' engagement metrics.
- Stylish form: vertical video aesthetics + surveillance POVs vs. brutal realism.

Synopsis

A mysterious invite lures nine creators—director, SFX artist, stuntman, AD, DP, sound tech, and a ‘perfect’ couple—to an all-night “competition.” The studio doors seal. A cold Voice lays out the rules: film a terrifying scene by deadline, hit the viral threshold, or someone dies. As their shorts blend into real carnage, egos fracture and alliances form; scripts are weaponized; film gear becomes lethal. Each day’s prompt escalates the mayhem until only a Final contestant remains to face a last, impossible choice—and the truth about who’s been watching.

DNA & References

A fresh hybrid built on proven audience obsessions

- SAW — Morality traps engineered from everyday film gear; every choice has a cost.
- SQUID GAME — Structured rounds, public spectacle, ruthless culling to one survivor.
- THE TRUMAN SHOW — Hidden cameras, meta-reality, the horror of being content.
- THE BELKO EXPERIMENT — Intercom overlord, kill-or-be-killed in a single sealed space.
- ESCAPE ROOM — Puzzle-box environments that weaponize design and psychology.

Characters — Leads

- LEXI (SFX Artist; ~3M followers): Goth-glam practical-effects ace; becomes the resourceful Final Girl.
- KAM (Director; ~10M): Vertical-film visionary and control freak; treats survival like a masterpiece in progress.

Characters — Friction

- TRISH & JOSH (3M combined): #CoupleGoals online, toxic off-camera; their brand cracks under real stakes.
- SYLVIA (Writer; off-grid): Brilliant, overlooked architect of the early scenes; her pages start predicting deaths.

Characters — Crew & Antagonist

- BRAD (Stuntman): Big-hearted daredevil; safety rigs can't save him when the set turns sentient.
- REBECCA (AD): Order vs. chaos; the rulebook burns.
- WILLY (DP): Gear-obsessed; the lens becomes a weapon and a witness.
- MARK (Sound): Calm, observant; the mix reveals the game's tells.
- THE VOICE: The unseen showrunner; part puppet-master, part algorithm, all audience appetite.

The World & Tone

- One haunted soundstage: hospital wings, locker banks, boiler rooms, house facades—modular and malevolent.
- Constant voyeurism: omnipresent cams, PA decrees, red tally lights; performance never stops.
- Elevated dread with satirical bite: the spectacle of suffering as entertainment.

Structure — Escalation by Day

- DAY 1: First prompt; a 'scene' ends in a fatal on-set "accident."
- DAY 2: Bigger, bloodier; virality demands they cut tragedy into the edit.
- DAY 3: Metrics = morality; refusal triggers punishment; trust collapses.
- DAY 4: Betrayal mechanics; the set literally reconfigures against them.
- FINAL DAY: Final Girl vs. the system; finish the film or become it.

Visual Style

Slick verticals vs. raw surveillance

- Dual language: 9:16 “content” frames (likes, chat overlays) vs. widescreen ‘real’ dread.
- Surveillance POVs & hard practicals; neon-meets-industrial palette; digital glitches as punctuation.
- Sound as weapon: PA taunts, UI pings, dead air; score swells only when the Voice wants it.

The Twist / Finale

- The doors open to a live studio audience—our Final Girl was content all along.
- The viewers were complicit spectators, voting with attention; survival equals ratings.
- A brutal mirror: fame, fandom, and the algorithm as the true killer influence.

Filmmaker Vision & Themes

- Elevated horror with social bite: influencer masks vs. authentic selves under mortal stakes.
- Audience complicity: we watch, we trend, we decide; the spectacle devours the performers.
- A contained, stylish pressure-cooker designed for bold set-pieces and conversation.